

M1911A1 Pistol

PAGES FROM THE ORIGINAL MANUAL

FM 23-35, Basic Field Manual – Automatic Pistol, Caliber .45, M1911 and M1911A1 (War Department, 1940)

WHAT'S INSIDE

Chapter 1, Mechanical Training: description, the cut-away drawing, taking it apart and putting it back together, cleaning, how it works, ammunition and safety.

23 pages from the original follow: the manual's cover, then the section about this weapon. Original US Government publication (public domain). Scans courtesy of the Internet Archive and Wikimedia Commons.

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FM 23-35

WAR DEPARTMENT

BASIC FIELD MANUAL



**AUTOMATIC PISTOL
CALIBER .45
M1911 AND M1911A¹**

BASIC FIELD MANUAL

AUTOMATIC PISTOL, CALIBER .45, M1911 AND M1911A1

(The matter contained herein supersedes TR 1300-45A, January 3, 1938, and chapter 3, part one, Basic Field Manual, volume III, April 5, 1932.)

CHAPTER 1

MECHANICAL TRAINING

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SECTION I

DESCRIPTION

■ 1. GENERAL.—*a.* The automatic pistols, caliber .45, M1911 and M1911A1, are recoil-operated, magazine-fed, self-loading hand weapons (figs. 1 and 2). The gas generated in a cartridge fired in the pistol is utilized to perform the functions of extracting and ejecting the empty cartridge case, cocking the hammer and forcing the slide to the rearmost position, thereby compressing the recoil spring. The action of the recoil spring forces the slide forward, feeding a live cartridge from the magazine into the chamber, leaving the weapon ready to fire again.

b. The M1911A1 pistol is a modification of the M1911 pistol. The operation of both models of pistols is exactly the same. The changes consist of the following (fig. 2):

(1) The tang of the grip safety is extended better to protect the hand.

(2) A clearance cut is made on the receiver for the trigger finger.

- (3) The face of the trigger is cut back and knurled.
- (4) The mainspring housing is raised in the form of a curve to fit the palm of the hand and is knurled.
- (5) The top of the front sight is widened.



FIGURE 1.—Automatic pistol, caliber .45, M1911.

c. The pistol is designed to fire cartridge, ball, caliber .45, M1911. The magazine holds seven cartridges. The upper cartridge is stripped from the magazine and forced into the chamber by the forward motion of the slide. The pistol fires but once at each squeeze of the trigger. When the last

cartridge in the magazine has been fired the slide remains open. The magazine catch is then depressed and the empty magazine falls out. A loaded magazine is then inserted, making seven more shots available.

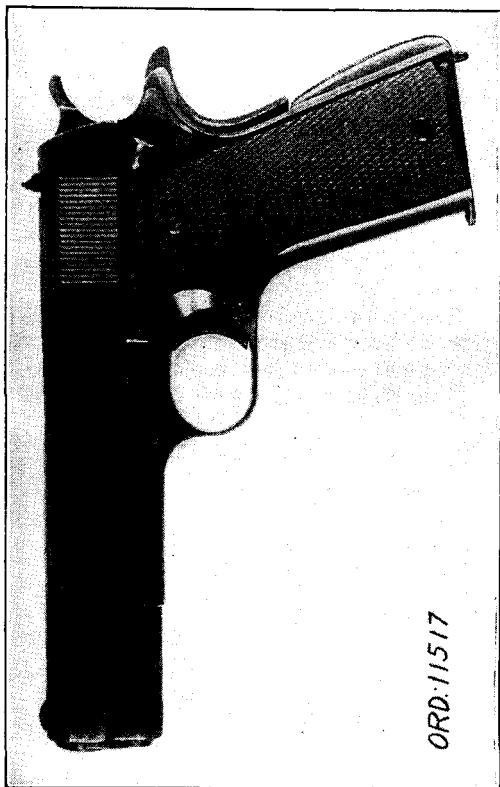


FIGURE 2.—Automatic pistol, caliber .45, M1911A1.

d. The rate of fire is limited by the dexterity of the operator in inserting magazines into the pistol and the ability of the firer to aim and squeeze.

■ 2. GENERAL DATA.—*a. Dimensions.*

(1) *Barrel.*

Caliber of bore_____inches__ 0.45

Number of grooves----- 6

Twist in rifling, uniform L. H., one turn in
inches-- 16

Length of barrel-----do----- 5.03

(2) *Pistol.*

Overall length of pistol-----inches-- 8.593

Height of front sight above axis of bore--do-- 0.5597

b. *Weights.*

Weight of pistol with magazine-----pounds__ 2.437

Weight of loaded magazine, 7 rounds (approximate) -----do----- 0.481

Weight of empty magazine-----do-- 0.156

c. *Trigger pull.*

Pistols, new or repaired-----pounds-- 5½ to 6½

Pistols, in hands of troops-----do-- 5 to 6½

d. Exterior ballistics.—(1) *Accuracy with muzzle rest.*—

The figures indicated below represent the mean variations for several targets.

Range	Mean radius	Mean vertical deviation
<i>Yards</i>	<i>Inches</i>	<i>Inches</i>
25	0.86	0.62
50	1.36	0.91
75	2.24	1.42

(2) *Drift.*—The drift or deviation due to the rifling in this pistol is to the left, but is more than neutralized by the pull of the trigger when the pistol is fired from the right hand. The drift is slight at short ranges and that for long ranges is immaterial, inasmuch as the pistol is a comparatively short-range weapon.

(3) *Velocity with striking energy.*

Range	Velocity	Energy	Range	Velocity	Energy
<i>Yards</i>	<i>Feet per second</i>	<i>Foot-pounds</i>	<i>Yards</i>	<i>Feet per second</i>	<i>Foot-pounds</i>
0	802	329	150	717	262
25	788	317	175	704	253
50	773	305	200	691	244
75	758	294	225	678	235
100	744	283	250	666	226
125	730	272			

(4) *Penetration in white pine.*

Range	Depth	Range	Depth
<i>Yards</i>	<i>Inches</i>	<i>Yards</i>	<i>Inches</i>
25	6.0	150	5.2
50	5.8	200	4.6
75	5.6	250	4.0
100	5.5		

A penetration of 1 inch in white pine corresponds to a dangerous wound. The penetration in moist loam at 25 yards is about 10 inches. The penetration in dry sand at 25 yards is about 8 inches.

(5) *Trajectory.*—The elevation required for 100 yards is 24' and for 200 yards about 1°. The elevation for 250 yards is about 1° 13'; the maximum ordinate being approximately 130 yards distance from the muzzle and about 51 inches in height. The maximum range is approximately 1,600 yards at an angle of elevation of 30°. The maximum ordinate for the maximum range is approximately 2,000 feet.

SECTION II

DISASSEMBLING AND ASSEMBLING

■ 3. DISASSEMBLING (see fig. 3).—*a.* Remove the magazine by pressing the magazine catch.

b. Press the recoil spring plug inward and turn the barrel bushing to the right until the recoil spring plug and the end

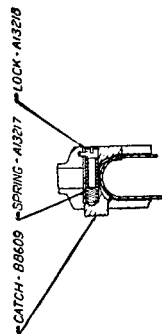
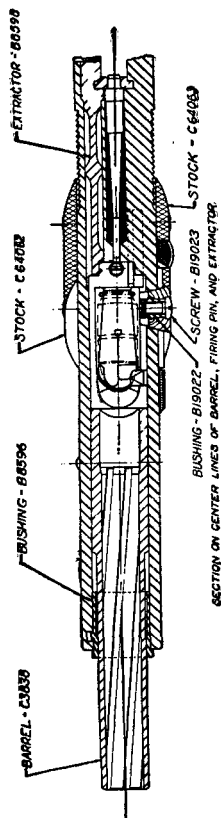
of the recoil spring protrude from their seat, releasing the tension of the recoil spring. As the recoil spring plug is allowed to protrude from its seat, the finger or thumb should be kept over it so that it will not jump away and be lost or strike the operator. Draw the slide rearward until the smaller rear recess in its lower left edge stands above the projection on the thumbpiece of the slide stop; press gently against the end of the pin of the slide stop which protrudes from the right side of the receiver above the trigger guard and remove the slide stop.

c. This releases the barrel link, allowing the barrel with the barrel link and the slide to be drawn forward together from the receiver, carrying with them the barrel bushing, recoil spring, recoil spring plug, and recoil spring guide.

d. Remove these parts from the slide by withdrawing the recoil spring guide from the rear of the recoil spring and drawing the recoil spring plug and the recoil spring forward from the slide. Turn recoil spring plug to right to remove from recoil spring. Turn the barrel bushing to the left until it may be drawn forward from the slide. This releases the barrel which with the barrel link may be drawn forward from the slide, and by pushing out the barrel link pin the barrel link is released from the barrel.

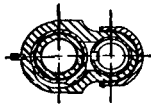
e. Press the rear end of the firing pin forward until it clears the firing pin stop which is then drawn downward from its seat in the slide; the firing pin, firing pin spring, and extractor are then removed from the rear of the slide.

f. The safety lock is readily withdrawn from the receiver by cocking the hammer and pushing from the right on the pin part or pulling outward on the thumbpiece of the safety lock when it is midway between its upper and lower positions. The cocked hammer is then lowered and removed after removing the hammer pin from the left side of the receiver. The mainspring housing pin is then pushed out from the right side of the receiver which allows the mainspring housing to be withdrawn downward and the grip safety rearward from the handle. The sear spring may then be removed. By pushing out the sear pin from the right to the left side of the receiver, the sear and the disconnector are released.



SECTION B-B
MAGAZINE LOCKED BY MAGAZINE CATCH

(Top of Fig. 3)



SECTION A-A
BARREL BUSHING LOCK IN POSITION

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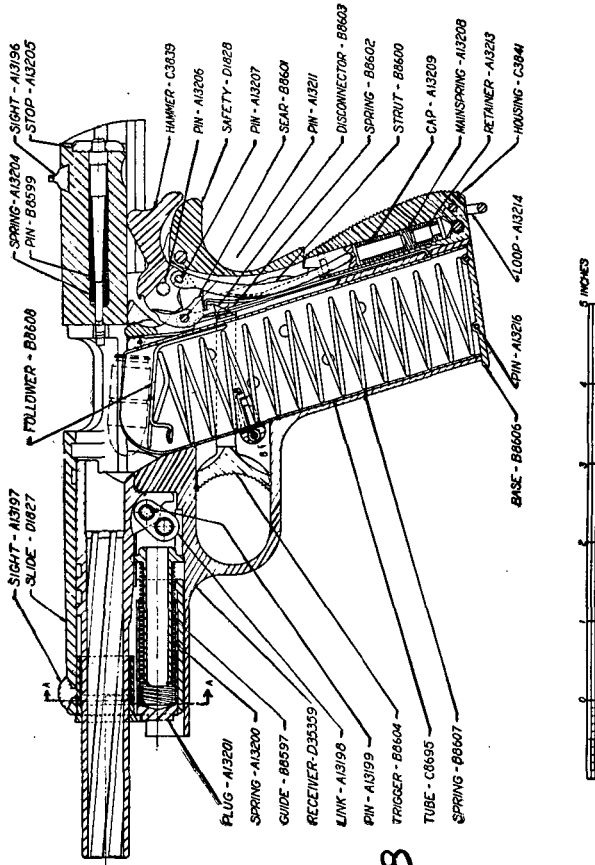


FIGURE 3.—Automatic pistol, caliber .45, M1911A1, sectional views.

(Insert between pp. 6 and 7)

g. To remove the mainspring, mainspring cap, and housing pin retainer from the mainspring housing, compress the mainspring and push out the small mainspring cap pin.

h. To remove the magazine catch from the receiver, its checkered left end must be pressed inward, when the right end of the magazine catch will project so far from the right side of the receiver that it may be rotated one-half turn. This movement will release the magazine-catch lock from its seat in the receiver, when the magazine catch, the magazine catch lock, and the magazine catch spring may be removed.

i. With the improved design of magazine catch lock the operation of dismounting the magazine catch is simplified. When the magazine catch has been pressed inward the magazine catch lock is turned a quarter turn to the left by means of a screw driver, or the short leaf of the sear spring. The magazine catch with its contents can then be removed. The improved design will be recognized from the fact that the head of the magazine catch lock is slotted.

j. The trigger can then be removed rearward from the receiver.

k. The hammer strut or the long arm of the screw driver can be used to push out all the pins except the mainspring cap pin, lanyard loop pin, and ejector pin.

l. The slide stop plunger, the safety lock plunger, and the plunger spring may be pushed to the rear out of the plunger tube.

m. The magazine should not be disassembled except for cleaning or to replace the magazine follower or magazine spring. To disassemble proceed as follows: Push the magazine follower downward about one-fourth inch; this compresses the magazine spring. Insert the end of a drift through one of the small holes in the side of the magazine to hold the magazine spring, then slide out the magazine follower. Hold hand over end of the magazine before removing drift from hole to prevent magazine spring from jumping away.

■ 4. ASSEMBLING.—*a.* Proceed in the reverse order.

b. It should be noted that the disconnecter and sear are assembled as follows: Place the cylindrical part of the dis-

connector in its hole in the receiver with the flat face of the lower part of the disconnector resting against the yoke of the trigger. Then place the sear, lugs downward, so that it straddles the disconnector. The sear pin is then inserted in place so that it passes through both the disconnector and the sear.

c. The sear, disconnector, and hammer being in place and the hammer down, to replace the sear spring, locate its lower end in the cut in the receiver with the end of the long leaf resting on the sear; then insert the mainspring housing until its lower end projects below the frame about one-eighth inch, replace the grip safety, cock the hammer, and replace the safety lock; then lower the cocked hammer, push the mainspring housing home, and insert the mainspring housing pin.

d. In assembling the safety lock to the receiver use the tip of the magazine follower or the screw driver to press the safety lock plunger home, thus allowing the seating of the safety lock. It should be remembered that when assembling the safety lock the hammer must be cocked.

e. When replacing the slide and barrel on the receiver care must be taken that the barrel link is tilted forward as far as possible and that the barrel link pin is in place.

SECTION III

CARE AND CLEANING

■ 5. GENERAL.—a. Careful, conscientious work is required to keep automatic pistols in a condition that will insure perfect functioning of the mechanism and continued accuracy of the barrel. It is essential that the entire mechanism is kept cleaned and oiled to avoid jams.

b. The mechanism also requires care to prevent rust or an accumulation of sand or dirt in the interior. Pistols are easily disassembled for cleaning and oiling.

■ 6. CARE AND CLEANING.—a. Care and cleaning of the pistol include the ordinary case of the pistol to preserve its condition and appearance in garrisons, posts, and camps, and in campaign.

b. Damp air and sweaty hands are great promoters of rust. The pistols should be cleaned and protected after every drill or handling. Special precautions are necessary when the pistols have been used on rainy days and after tours of guard duty.

c. To clean the pistol rub it with a rag which has been lightly oiled and then clean with a perfectly dry rag. Swab the bore with an oily flannel patch and then with a perfectly dry one. Dust out all crevices with a small, clean brush.

d. Immediately after cleaning, to protect the pistol swab the bore thoroughly with a flannel patch saturated with sperm oil, wipe over all metal parts with an oily rag, applying a few drops of light oil (sperm oil) to all cams and working surfaces of the mechanism.

e. After cleaning and protecting the pistol, place it in the pistol rack without any covering whatever. The use of canvas or similar covers is prohibited, as they collect moisture and rust the metal parts. While barracks are being swept, pistol racks will be covered with a piece of canvas to protect the pistols from dust.

■ 7. CARE AND CLEANING AFTER FIRING.—a. When a pistol has been fired the bore will be cleaned thoroughly not later than the evening of the day on which it is fired. Thereafter it will be cleaned and oiled each day for at least the next three succeeding days.

b. To clean the bore after firing, first remove the slide and barrel, insert the muzzle of the barrel in a vessel containing hot water and issue soap, hot water alone, or cold water; the cleaning rod with a cloth patch assembled is inserted in the breech and moved forward and back for about 1 minute, pumping the water in and out of the bore. When the bore is wet, a brass or bronze wire brush, if available, should be run all the way through the bore, then all the way back three or four times. Water should again be pumped through the bore. Then wipe the cleaning rod dry, remove the barrel from the water, and using dry, clean flannel patches thoroughly swab the bore until it is perfectly dry and clean. Examine the bore carefully for metal fouling.

CAUTION.—After firing do not oil the bore before cleaning.

c. Saturate a clean flannel patch with sperm oil and swab the bore and chamber with the patch, making certain that the bore and all metal parts of the pistol are covered with a thin coat of oil.

■ 8. RULES FOR CARE OF PISTOL ON THE RANGE.—a. Always clean at the end of each day's shooting. A pistol that has been fired should not be left over night without cleaning.

b. Never fire a pistol with any dust, dirt, mud, or snow in the bore.

c. Before loading the pistol make sure that no patch, rag, or other object has been left in the barrel.

d. During range firing a noncommissioned officer will be placed in charge of the cleaning of pistols in the cleaning racks.

■ 9. CARE DURING COLD WEATHER.—Use oil sparingly on the working parts.

■ 10. CARE DURING GAS ATTACKS.—a. Pistols should be cleaned as soon as possible after a gas attack.

b. Oil will prevent corrosion for about 12 hours.

c. Clean all parts in boiling water containing a little soda, if available.

d. All traces of gas must be removed from ammunition with a slightly oiled rag; then thoroughly dry the ammunition.

e. Rust-preventive compound resists gas corrosion more than light oil. In many exposures, especially those of long duration, ammunition treated with sperm oil evidences more severe corrosion than unprotected cartridges.

■ 11. IMPORTANT POINTS TO BE OBSERVED.—a. After firing the pistol, never leave it uncleaned over night. The damage done is then irreparable.

b. Keep the pistol clean and lightly lubricated, but do not let it become gummy with oil.

c. Do not place the pistol on the ground where sand or dirt may enter the bore or mechanism.

d. Do not plug the muzzle of the pistol with a patch or plug. One may forget to remove it before firing, in which case the discharge may bulge or burst the barrel at the muzzle.

e. A pistol kept in a leather holster may rust due to mois-

ture absorbed by the leather from the atmosphere, even though the holster may appear to be perfectly dry. If the holster is wet and the pistol must be carried therein, cover the pistol with a thick coat of oil.

f. The hammer should not be snapped when the pistol is partially disassembled.

g. The trigger should be pulled with the forefinger. If the trigger is pulled with the second finger, the forefinger extending along the side of the receiver is apt to press against the projecting pin of the slide stop and cause a malfunction when the slide recoils.

h. Pressure on the trigger must be released sufficiently after each shot to permit the trigger to reengage the sear.

i. To remove cartridges not fired, disengage the magazine slightly and then extract the cartridge in the barrel by drawing back the slide.

j. Care should be taken to see that the magazine is not dented or otherwise damaged.

k. Care must be exercised in inserting the magazine to insure its engaging with the magazine catch. Never insert the magazine and strike it smartly with the hand to force it home, as this may spring the base or the inturning lips at the top. It should be inserted by a quick continuous movement.

SECTION IV

FUNCTIONING

■ 12. METHOD OF OPERATION.—*a.* A loaded magazine is placed in the receiver and the slide drawn fully back and released, thus bringing the first cartridge into the chamber. (If the slide is open push down the slide stop to let the slide go forward.) The hammer is thus cocked and the pistol is ready for firing.

b. If it is desired to make the pistol ready for instant use and for firing the maximum number of shots with the least possible delay, draw back the slide, insert a cartridge by hand into the chamber of the barrel, allow the slide to close, then lock the slide and the cocked hammer by pressing the safety lock upward and insert a loaded magazine. The slide and hammer being thus positively locked, the pistol may be carried

safely at full cock and it is only necessary to press down the safety lock (which is located within easy reach of the thumb) when raising the pistol to the firing position.

c. The grip safety is provided with an extending horn which not only serves as a guard to prevent the hand of the shooter from slipping upward and being struck or injured by the hammer, but also aids in accurate shooting by keeping the hand in the same position for each shot and, furthermore, permits the lowering of the cocked hammer with one hand by automatically pressing in the grip safety when the hammer is drawn slightly beyond the cocked position. In order to release the hammer, the grip safety must be pressed in before the trigger is squeezed.

■ 13. SAFETY DEVICES.—*a.* It is impossible for the firing pin to discharge or even touch the primer except on receiving the full blow of the hammer.

b. The pistol is provided with two automatic safety devices:

(1) The disconnector, which positively prevents the release of the hammer unless the slide and barrel are in the forward position and safely interlocked. This device also controls the firing and prevents more than one shot from following each squeeze of the trigger.

(2) The grip safety which at all times locks the trigger unless the handle is firmly grasped and the grip safety pressed in.

c. In addition, the pistol is provided with a safety lock by which the closed slide and the cocked hammer can be positively locked in position.

■ 14. DETAILED FUNCTIONING.—*a.* The magazine may be charged with any number of cartridges from one to seven.

b. The charged magazine is inserted in the receiver and the slide drawn once to the rear. This movement cocks the hammer, compresses the recoil spring, and when the slide reaches the rear position the magazine follower raises the upper cartridge into the path of the slide. The slide is then released and being forced forward by the recoil spring carries the first cartridge into the chamber of the barrel. As the slide approaches its forward position, it encounters the rear extension of the barrel and forces the barrel forward; the rear end of the barrel swings upward on the barrel link, turn-

ing on the muzzle end as on a fulcrum. When the slide and barrel reach their forward position they are positively locked together by the locking ribs on the barrel and their joint forward movement is arrested by the barrel lug encountering the pin on the slide top. The pistol is then ready for firing.

c. When the hammer is cocked the hammer strut moves downward, compressing the mainspring, and the sear under action of the long leaf of the sear spring engages its nose in the notch on the hammer. In order that the pistol may be fired the following conditions must exist:

(1) The grip safety must be pressed in, leaving the trigger free to move.

(2) The slide must be in its forward position, properly interlocked with the barrel so that the disconnector is held in the recess on the under side of the slide under the action of the sear spring, transmitting in this position any motion of the trigger to the sear.

(3) The safety lock must be down in the unlocked position so that the sear will be unblocked and free to release the hammer and the slide will be free to move back.

d. On squeezing the trigger, the sear is moved and the released hammer strikes the firing pin which transmits the blow to the primer of the cartridge. The pressure of the gases generated in the barrel by the explosion of the powder in the cartridge is exerted in a forward direction against the bullet, driving it through the bore, and in a rearward direction against the face of the slide, driving the latter and the barrel to the rear together. The downward swinging movement of the barrel unlocks it from the slide and the barrel is then stopped in its lowest position. The slide continues to move to the rear, opening the breech, cocking the hammer, extracting and ejecting the empty shell, and compressing the recoil spring until the slide reaches its rear-most position when another cartridge is raised in front of it and forced into the chamber of the barrel by the return movement of the slide under pressure of the recoil spring.

e. The weight and consequently the inertia of the slide augmented by those of the barrel are so many times greater than the weight and inertia of the bullet that the latter has been given its maximum velocity and has been driven from the muzzle of the barrel before the slide and barrel have re-

coiled to the point where the barrel commences its unlocking movement. This construction therefore delays the opening of the breech of the barrel until after the bullet has left the muzzle and therefore practically prevents the escape of any of the powder gases to the rear after the breech has been opened. This factor of safety is further increased by the tension of the recoil spring and mainspring, both of which oppose the rearward movement of the slide.

f. While the comparatively great weight of the slide of the pistol insures safety against premature opening of the breech, it also insures operation of the pistol because at the point of the rearward opening movement where the barrel is unlocked and stopped the heavy slide has attained a momentum which is sufficient to carry it through its complete opening movement and makes the pistol ready for another shot.

g. When the magazine has been emptied, the pawl-shaped slide stop is raised by the magazine follower under action of the magazine spring into the front recess on the lower left side of the slide, thereby locking the slide in the open position and serving as an indicator to remind the shooter that the empty magazine must be replaced by a loaded one before the firing can be continued. Pressure upon the magazine catch quickly releases the empty magazine from the receiver and permits the insertion of a loaded magazine.

h. To release the slide from the open position, it is only necessary to press upon the thumbpiece of the slide stop, then the slide will go forward to its closed position, carrying a cartridge from the previously inserted magazine into the barrel and making the pistol ready for firing again.

SECTION V

SPARE PARTS AND ACCESSORIES

■ 15. SPARE PARTS.—In time certain parts of the pistol become unserviceable through breakage or wear resulting from continuous usage. For this reason spare parts are provided for replacement purposes. They should be kept clean and lightly oiled to prevent rust. They are divided into two groups; spare parts and basic spare parts.

a. Spare parts.—These are extra parts provided with the pistol for replacement of the parts most likely to fail, for

use in making minor repairs, and in general care of the pistol. Sets of spare parts should be kept complete at all times. Whenever a spare part is taken to replace a defective part in the pistol, the defective part should be repaired or a new one substituted in the spare part set as soon as possible. The allowance of these spare parts is prescribed in SNL B-6.

b. Basic spare parts.—These are sets of parts provided for the use of ordnance maintenance companies and include all parts necessary to repair the pistol. The allowance of basic spare parts is prescribed in the addendum to SNL B-6.

■ 16. ACCESSORIES.—The names or general characteristics of many of the accessories required with the automatic pistol indicate their use and application. They consist of the holster, lanyard, and pistol cleaning kit, and for post, camp, or station issue, arm lockers and arm racks. The pistol cleaning kit contains cleaning brushes and rods, pistol screwdrivers, an oiler, and a small brass can in which the set of spare parts is carried.

SECTION VI

AMMUNITION

■ 17. GENERAL.—The information in this section pertaining to the ammunition authorized for use in the automatic pistol, cal. .45, M1911 and M1911A1, includes a description of the cartridges, means of identification, care, use, and ballistic data.

■ 18. CLASSIFICATION.—The types of ammunition provided for this pistol are—

- a. Ball, for use against personnel and light matériel targets.*
- b. Dummy, for training (cartridges are inert).*

■ 19. AMMUNITION LOT NUMBER.—When ammunition is manufactured an ammunition lot number which becomes an essential part of the marking is assigned in accordance with pertinent specifications. This lot number is marked on all packing containers and on the identification card inclosed in each packing box. It is required for all purposes of record,

including grading and use, reports on condition, functioning and accidents, in which the ammunition might be involved. Only those lots of grades appropriate for the weapon will be fired. Since it is impractical to mark the ammunition lot number on each individual cartridge, every effort will be made to maintain the ammunition lot number with the cartridges once they are removed from their original packing. Cartridges which have been removed from the original packing and for which the ammunition lot number has been lost are placed in grade 3. It is therefore obvious that when cartridges are removed from their original packings they should be so marked that the ammunition lot number is preserved.

■ 20. GRADE.—AR 775-10 provides for the order in which lots and grades of ammunition are to be used. Ordnance Field Service Bulletin No. 3-5 lists numerically every lot of small-arms ammunition with its correct grade as established by the office of the Chief of Ordnance. Only lots of proper grade will be fired. *Grade 3 indicates unserviceable ammunition and will not be fired.*

■ 21. IDENTIFICATION.—*a. Markings.*—The contents of original boxes are readily identified by the markings on the box. Similar markings on the carton label identify the contents of each carton.

b. Color bands.—Color bands painted on the sides and ends of the packing boxes further identify the various types of ammunition. The following color bands are used:

Cartridge, ball-----	Red.
Cartridge, dummy-----	Green.

c. Types and models.—One model of caliber .45 ball cartridge and one model of caliber .45 dummy cartridge are authorized for use in the caliber .45 automatic pistol. These cartridges are designated—

(1) Cartridge, ball, cal. .45, M1911.

(2) Cartridge, dummy, cal. .45, M1921.

The dummy cartridge is distinguished by its cartridge case which is tinned and has a 1/8-inch hole in the body.

■ 22. CARE, HANDLING, AND PRESERVATION.—*a. Small-arms ammunition as compared with other types is not dangerous*

to handle. However, care must be observed to keep the boxes from becoming broken or damaged. All broken boxes must be immediately repaired and careful attention given so that all markings are transferred to the new parts of the box. The metal liner should be air-tested and sealed if equipment for this work is available.

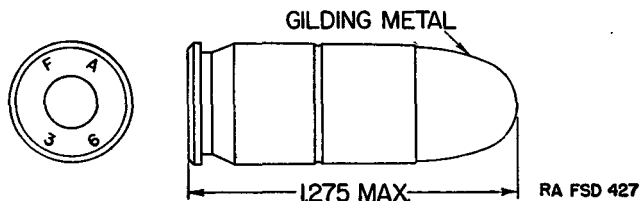


FIGURE 4.—Cartridge, ball, cal. .45, M1911.

b. Ammunition boxes should not be opened until the ammunition is required for use. Ammunition removed from the airtight container, particularly in damp climates, is apt to corrode, thereby causing the ammunition to become unserviceable.

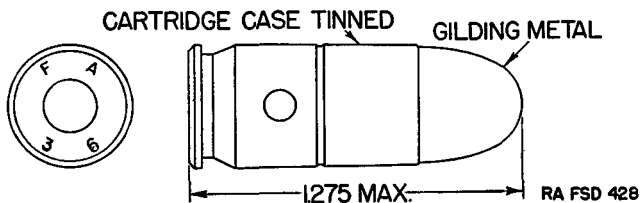


FIGURE 5.—Cartridge, dummy, cal. .45, M1921.

c. Carefully protect the ammunition from mud, sand, dirt, and water. If it gets wet or dirty wipe it off at once. If verdigris or light corrosion forms on cartridges, it should be wiped off. However, cartridges should not be polished to make them look better or brighter.

d. The use of oil or grease on cartridges is dangerous and is prohibited.

e. Do not fire dented cartridges, cartridges with loose bullets, or otherwise defective rounds.

f. Do not allow the ammunition to be exposed to the direct rays of the sun for any length of time. This is liable to affect seriously its firing qualities.

g. No caliber .45 ammunition will be fired until it has been positively identified by ammunition lot number and grade as published in the latest revision or change to Ordnance Field Service Bulletin No. 3-5.

■ 23. STORAGE.—*a.* Whenever practicable small-arms ammunition should be stored under cover. Should it become necessary to leave small-arms ammunition in the open it should be raised on dunnage at least 6 inches from the ground and the pile covered with a double thickness of paulin. Suitable trenches should be dug to prevent water flowing under the pile.

b. Fire hazard.—If fired into or placed in a fire, small-arms ammunition does not explode violently. There are small individual explosions of each cartridge, the case flying in one direction and the bullet in another. In case of fire it is advisable to keep those not engaged in fighting the fire at least 200 yards from the fire and have them lie on the ground. It is unlikely that the bullets and cases will fly over 200 yards.

■ 24. BALLISTIC DATA.—*a.* Average velocity at 25 feet from muzzle, 800 feet per second.

b. Approximate maximum range, 1,600 yards.

SECTION VII

INDIVIDUAL SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

■ 25. RULES FOR SAFETY.—Before ball ammunition is issued, the soldier must know the essential rules for safety with the pistol. The following rules are taught as soon as the recruit is sufficiently familiar with the pistol to understand them. They should be enforced by constant repetition and coaching until their observance becomes the soldier's fixed habit when handling the pistol. When units carrying the pistol are first formed, the officer or noncommissioned officer in charge causes the men to execute INSPECTION PISTOL.

a. Execute UNLOAD every time the pistol is picked up for any purpose. Never trust your memory. Consider every pistol as loaded until you have proved it otherwise.

b. Always unload the pistol if it is to be left where someone else may handle it.

c. Always point the pistol up when snapping it after examination. Keep the hammer fully down when the pistol is not loaded.

d. Never place the finger within the trigger guard until you intend to fire or to snap for practice.

e. *Never point the pistol at anyone you do not intend to shoot, nor in a direction where an accidental discharge may do harm.* On the range, do not snap for practice while standing back of the firing line.

f. Before loading the pistol, draw back the slide and look through the bore to see that it is free from obstruction.

g. On the range, do not insert a loaded magazine until the time for firing.

h. Never turn around at the firing point while you hold a loaded pistol in your hand, because by so doing you may point it at the man firing alongside of you.

i. On the range, do not load the pistol with a cartridge in the chamber until immediate use is anticipated. If there is any delay, lock the pistol and only unlock it while extending the arm to fire. Do not lower the hammer on a loaded cartridge; the pistol is much safer cocked and locked.

j. In reducing a jam *first remove the magazine.*

k. To remove a cartridge not fired *first remove the magazine* and then extract the cartridge from the chamber by drawing back the slide.

l. In campaign, when early use of the pistol is not foreseen, it should be carried with a fully loaded magazine in the socket, chamber empty, hammer down. When early use of the pistol is probable, it should be carried loaded and locked in the holster or hand. In campaign, extra magazines should be carried fully loaded.

m. When the pistol is carried in the holster loaded, cocked, and locked the butt should be rotated away from the body when drawing the pistol in order to avoid displacing the safety lock.

n. Safety devices should be frequently tested. A safety device is a dangerous device if it does not work when expected.

■ 26. TESTS.—*a. Safety lock.*—Cock the hammer and then press the safety lock upward into the safe position. Grasp the stock so that the grip safety is depressed and squeeze the trigger three or four times. If the hammer falls, the safety lock is not safe and must be repaired.

b. Grip safety.—Cock the hammer and, being careful not to depress the grip safety, point pistol downward and squeeze the trigger three or four times. If the hammer falls or the grip safety is depressed by its own weight, the grip safety is not safe and must be repaired.

c. Half-cock notch.—Draw back the hammer until the sear engages the half-cock notch and squeeze the trigger. If the hammer falls, the hammer or sear must be replaced or repaired. Draw the hammer back nearly to full cock and then let it slip. It should fall only to half cock.

d. Disconnecter.—Cock the hammer. Shove the slide one-quarter inch to the rear; hold slide in that position and squeeze the trigger. Let the slide go forward, maintaining the pressure on the trigger. If the hammer falls, the disconnecter is worn on top and must be replaced. Pull the slide all the way to the rear and engage the slide stop. Squeeze the trigger and at the same time release the slide. The hammer should not fall. Release the pressure on the trigger and then squeeze it. The hammer should then fall. The disconnecter prevents the release of the hammer unless the slide and barrel are in the forward position safely interlocked. It also prevents more than one shot following each squeeze of the trigger.